Kazakhstan, and Nigeria, for both military and security operations. It has been used for:

- Border surveillance and coastal monitoring.
- Counter-insurgency (COIN) and anti-terrorism operations.
- Reconnaissance and artillery spotting in desert and mountainous regions.
- Civil applications, such as disaster monitoring and environmental surveys.

The UAV's export-oriented design philosophy and affordability have made it an attractive option for developing nations seeking autonomous aerial capabilities comparable to Western systems but at significantly lower costs.

Strategic and technological significance

The Wing Loong I represents China's growing sophistication in UAV manufacturing and export. It marked China's entry into the global armed drone market, previously dominated by the United States and Israel. Its development underscores China's strategy of combining indigenous aerospace technology with affordability, accessibility, and multi-role functionality to dominate emerging defense markets.

Furthermore, the UAV laid the foundation for advanced Chinese platforms like the Wing Loong II and Wing Loong-10, which feature higher payloads, endurance, and improved sensors. By offering performance parity with Western UAVs at a fraction of the cost, the Wing Loong I reshaped the global landscape of unmanned aerial systems.

Key specifications:

- *Type*: Medium-altitude long-endurance (MALE) UAV